In May 2007, OECD countries agreed to invite Chile, Estonia, Israel, Russia and Slovenia to open discussions for membership of the Organisation and offered enhanced engagement to Brazil, China, India, Indonesia and South Africa.

Chile became a member of the Organisation on May 7, 2010, Slovenia became a member on July 21, 2010 and Israel became a member on September 7, 2010. On December 9, 2010, Estonia became a member, once necessary formalities, including parliamentary approval, were completed.

While enhanced engagement is distinct from **accession** to the OECD, it has the potential in the future to lead to membership. The approval of so-called 'road maps' marked the start of accession talks with Chile, Estonia, Israel, Russia and Slovenia. The accession procedure is complex and can be long, as it involves a series of examinations to assess a country's ability to meet OECD standards in a wide range of policy areas. This makes it difficult to bring on board more than a small number of new members at the same time.

WORLD TRADE ORGANISATION (WTO)

The World Trade Organisation (WTO) came into being as a result of the evolution of the multilateral trading system starting with the establishment of the General Agreement on Tariffs and Trade (GATT) in 1947. The protracted Uruguay Round negotiations spanning the period 1986–1994, which resulted in the establishment of the WTO, substantially extended the reach of multilateral rules and disciplines related to trade in goods, and introduced multilateral rules applicable to trade in agriculture (Agreement on Agriculture), trade in services (General Agreement on Trade in Services —GATS) as well as Trade Related Intellectual Property Rights (TRIPS). A separate understanding on WTO dispute settlement mechanism (DSU) and trade policy review mechanism (TPRM) was also agreed upon.

WTO and India